

We stopped hunting a gate that works every day. We started building the thing that picks the right gate for the day.

This was the cut-over week – the desk moved to V7 mid-week – so the shadow board is only three days deep. But one tape observation cracked open the week's real prize: **the day-type router**. It has a first walk-forward, and it holds up out of sample.

Desk **FLAT •
HEALTHY**

V7 • MNQ • paper 28 shadow sims nothing armed

Scope note – read this first. The desk cut over to GAZBOT V7 on Tue, so V7 shadow capture is only ~3 days old. This is *not* the 51-section census of Rev 3 – the data doesn't exist yet, and I won't pad it. Where I needed depth I went to the **V5 archive (25 days of MNQ)** and replayed the V7 gates over it honestly. The full weekly census returns once V7 has a full week on the board. Voice and spine follow last week's Rev 3; the report prescribes, you decide.

01 WHAT'S WORKING, WHAT'S BLEEDING, WHAT TO DO MONDAY

The one thing to take away: no single gate is the answer, and chasing one is the trap we just climbed out of. **grind_fast (#22)** – the momentum sim that lit up today at **+\$1,401** – is a **^'\$7,895** loser over 25 days. It only prints on run days and bleeds every chop day. That's not a flaw to fix; it's a **specialist**. Its mirror, the reversion sim **#23**, is quietly **+\$723** over the same 25 days and survives the chop that kills grind.

The money isn't in either gate. It's in **knowing which day you're in and running the gate that fits** – the router. And the first walk-forward says the router beats both halves out of sample.

If you read nothing else:

Monday: don't run grind live. It failed its survival test standalone. **Build the router instead** – route on early directional movement, run grind only when the day opens directional, run rev otherwise. All shadow-first.

It started with something you spotted on the tape: on the same `thrust` gate, same day, **shorts made +\$321 while longs bled ^'\$389**. Direction alone flipped the day. Pull that thread and it doesn't stop at direction “ it's the whole idea that **each day suits a different gate, and we should let the tape tell us which**.

So we replayed the two clearest specialists “ `grind_fast` (#22, run-days) and `rg_long_fast_v` (#23, chop) “ over 25 archived MNQ days, and tested whether an **early-day read** could pick the winner.

The walk-forward “ tuned on the first 12 days, tested blind on the last 13

Out-of-sample test window “ total P&L “ ceiling basis (optimistic “ real is worse, but the ranking holds):

always grind	^'\$4,447	
router “ ATR	^'\$4,006	
router “ efficiency		+ \$135
always rev		+ \$316
router “ move “ ...		+\$1,572

“... Route on early **directional displacement** “ has price actually travelled ¥ 153 pts in the first four hours? “ and the out-of-sample result is **+\$1,572**. It beat `always-grind` by ~\$6k and beat `always-rev`, the harder bar to clear.

What the walk-forward actually taught us

- **Directional movement is the tell; volatility is a trap.** The move-based router held up out of sample. The ATR-based one **collapsed to ^'\$4,006** “ the third time now that vol level has failed as a day-type read. Stop reaching for ATR.
- **The veto is cleaner than the go.** When the first four hours are choppy, grind went **0-for-9 green** at ^'\$776/day. "Stand grind down on a quiet open" is rock-solid. Deciding when to switch it on is where the noise still lives.
- **The day isn't static.** Today ran directional overnight, chopped dead 08:00“12:00, then broke out 14:00“16:00. A one-shot morning verdict misses the afternoon “ the router has to keep re-checking, not lock in at 10am. (You called this: "if we switch, we keep simulating the dropped side to make sure we were right.")

03 THE WINNERS " LEAN INTO THESE

SIM	READ	TODAY	25-DAY	VERDICT
#23 rg_long_fast_v	reversion / chop floor	^ '\$155	+\$723	KEEP · TUNE
#22 grind_fast	run-day specialist	+\$1,401	^ '\$7,895	ROUTER ONLY

#23 is the quiet win of the week. You flagged it as "hopeful" and the archive backs you more than grind's fireworks did " it's net-green over 25 days and, crucially, it was flat-to-green on the very chop days that destroyed grind. It's the natural floor half of the router. The tuning path: a VWAP-slope veto so it stops fading into trends (the old reversion lesson), and an honest reprice to confirm the +\$723 isn't just ceiling optimism.

#22 is a winner only in a costume. Today it rode run after run " the top ten trades all exited on the chandelier, best +\$334 riding 128 points in 11 minutes. But standalone it's a ^ '\$7,895 disaster. It earns its place only as the run-day component behind the router. Never live on its own.

04 THE BLEEDERS " FIX OR RETIRE

The live chandelier is too loose for a high-ATR day

You watched a live long run to +\$224 and give back to +\$88. The chandelier fired correctly " but its give-back is k - ATR , and today's ATR was a huge 44 points. At a +\$224 peak the trail was still ~\$133 wide. Working as coded, too loose in dollars when vol spikes. Three tighter variants are now on the board (**#24 / #25 / #26**, start-k 3.5 / 2.5 / 2.0) to find the give-back that locks in more without clipping the runners. Verdict: **A/B RUNNING** " needs a chop day and a trend day before we touch the live trail.

grind, run every day

Covered above " ^ '\$7,895/25 days standalone. **RETIRE STANDALONE** , resurrect behind the router.

05 THE SMALL FRY " TOO NEW TO JUDGE

Shipped to the board this week, logging forward, no verdict yet:

- **#27 / #28 " the per-side circuit breaker.** Runs both sides, stands down the one that's clearly losing while the other clearly wins (threshold, not hard-and-fast), and keeps shadowing the dropped side to re-arm if it recovers. Offline over today it vetoed the longs at 11:28 and would have saved ~\$154. It's the direction-level version of the router " same reactive spine, one level down.
- **Chandelier A/B (#24"26)** " see the bleeders; accruing.

"Check the chandelier is working on the live desk “ that \$88 long went to \$224 and dropped back."

It's wired and firing correctly. The give-back scales with ATR, and today's ATR was extreme “ so it surrendered ~\$135 of a \$224 run by design, not by bug. “ three tighter variants on the board to A/B. “ answered

"Does it match the chandelier on the shadow desk?"

Byte-for-byte “ same function, same params on live, shadow-sim, and the repricer that scores the board. The shadow is a faithful test bench for the fix. “ confirmed

"Short and long on the live desk today “ shorts win, longs lose."

Confirmed and stark: shorts +\$321 (70% win) vs longs ^\$389 (29%) on the same gate. Direction flipped the day. “ became the whole router thread. “ the week's lead

"How early was that readable? Maybe lose a few early then confirm."

The scoreboard was decisive by ~09:41 and never flipped. But it's NOT a trend rule “ shorts won above and below VWAP. The tell is the realized per-side scoreboard, measured “ exactly your "lose a few, then confirm." “ built the circuit breaker (#27/#28). “ built

"Two or three chandeliers ready, pick the best for the day?"

Yes “ and the honest version isn't a daily switch you predict, it's a reactive read. The shadow board already gauges the day for free; the missing piece is the router that reads it. “ generalized into the day-type router. “ framed

"Don't trade the morning, just gauge the tape? Or ultra-tight stops to gauge?"

Don't blackout “ the shadow gauges for free, no morning sacrificed. And avoid tight stops: they'd choke a run-rider like grind and mis-read the day. Use small size + the real exit if you probe live. “ answered

"Sim 22 “ best momentum sim ever, put it live if it survives."

It didn't survive. ^\$7,895/25 days; today was its single best day and flattered it. The backtest caught it before it cost real money. “ router-only. “ tested, verdict in

"Dig into sim 23" could be a great chop reversion gate."

Your best call of the night. +\$723/25 days, survives chop, the floor half of the router. Still needs an honest reprice + a slope veto to prove clearly +EV. ... promoted to a lead

07 READ THIS BEFORE YOU GET EXCITED

- **n = 25 days, test = 13.** The +\$1,572 is one out-of-sample window on a single split. A lead, not a verdict.
- **Ceiling P&L is optimistic.** Real repriced numbers are worse everywhere " grind's "\$7,895 is if anything understated; rev's +\$723 is closer to breakeven than clearly green.
- **The threshold is raw points.** "153 pts" is regime-dependent and wants ATR-normalizing before it travels to another month.
- **V7 board is 3 days old.** The live-shadow numbers (#22 +\$1,401 etc.) are single-day. The archive replay is where the weight is.

08 WHAT TO DO MONDAY

1. **Build the router, don't arm a gate.** Rolling walk-forward on honestly-repriced P&L; ATR-normalize the displacement feature; test move + efficiency together.
2. **Make the router continuous** " re-evaluate through the day, not one morning call (today's character shifted twice).
3. **Tune #23 to clearly-green on chop** " add the VWAP-slope veto, reprice honestly. It's the floor half.
4. **Let the chandelier A/B and the circuit breaker accrue** " both want a chop day and a trend day before any verdict.
5. **Rewire the report pipeline for V7** so next Friday's census reads the V7 board " the backlog item this transition week exposed.

All shadow / research. Nothing arms without your say-so.

THE SHADOW DESK • GAZBOT V7 • week to 17 Jul 2026 • authored on the cut-over week
grind/rev replay + router walk-forward: V5 archive `bar_history`, 25d MNQ 1m, ceiling basis • live
desk untouched, flat & healthy at sign-off
voice + spine follow last week's Rev 3 • not the 51-section census " V7 board is 3 days deep,
full census returns with a full week of data